

A strategic and investor-ready business plan for Tellie, a voice-first companion and healthy-aging platform for older adults.

Tellie

Business Plan

Prepared for investors, strategic partners, and potential co-founders

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Tellie Business Plan

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Document Status

This document is a strategic and investor-style business plan drafted from the full conversation history provided by the founder. It is designed to be professional, compelling, and usable for:

- angel investors
- pre-seed investors
- potential co-founders
- pilot partners
- strategic advisors

Where data is not yet directly validated by Tellie's internal metrics, it is marked as an 'Assumption to validate'.

Executive Summary

Tellie is an empathetic technology platform designed specifically for older adults. It begins as a voice-first AI companion and is intended to evolve into a broader healthy-aging and digital-inclusion platform.

The core insight behind Tellie is simple: many older adults do not struggle because technology is unavailable to them, but because most technology is not designed for them. Interfaces are often complex, fast, cognitively demanding, and built for digitally native users. At the same time, aging populations across Australia, the United States, the United Kingdom, Canada, and New Zealand are facing rising loneliness, social isolation, and growing exclusion from an increasingly digital society.

Tellie addresses this by designing around a familiar behavior older adults already know: making a phone call. Rather than forcing seniors to learn a new interaction model, Tellie uses a voice-first, elder-driven interface that feels more like calling someone than using software. The product is built to be warm, simple, patient, and relationship-oriented.

Tellie's wedge is companionship. Its long-term platform opportunity is much larger: digital inclusion, healthy aging, family reassurance, community participation, and wellbeing support for older adults.

Tellie will initially launch with a hybrid B2C and B2B model:

- B2C subscriptions for older adults and adult children
- B2B distribution through councils, community centers, home care providers, and aged-care facilities

The long-term investment thesis is that Tellie can become the most trusted technology experience for older adults by combining senior-first design, longitudinal relationship memory, voice interaction, and institutional distribution.

Company Overview

Company

- Name: Tellie
- Tagline: Your daily companion
- Planned legal entity: Tellie Technologies Pty Ltd
- Launch geography: Australia
- Expansion markets: United States, United Kingdom, Canada, New Zealand

Mission

To ensure no older adult feels left behind in the digital world.

Vision

A world where every older adult has access to companionship, connection, and technology designed around their needs.

Core Values

- Empathy: technology should make older adults feel heard, respected, and supported
- Simplicity: technology should adapt to people, not the other way around
- Dignity: older adults deserve independence, confidence, and meaningful participation in modern life

Founder Story

Tellie was born from personal experience with loneliness and from observing the emotional impact of isolation among older adults, including within the founder's own family. The founder's experience as an immigrant reinforced the emotional cost of disconnection and informed the company's focus on connection, belonging, and human-centered technology.

Company History

Origins

Tellie was created from a simple belief: technology should serve humans, not the other way around. From the beginning, the company was shaped by the observation that while technology was becoming more powerful, many older adults were being left further behind by products that were not designed for their needs, confidence levels, or lived realities.

Product before funding

Tellie's early operating model was built around a two-founder structure in which product development and fundraising/growth responsibilities were intended to run in parallel. In practice, external capital for marketing and user acquisition did not materialize at the pace originally expected.

Rather than waiting for funding to begin execution, the company chose to continue building. That decision resulted in a working product being developed before institutional investment, significantly reducing technical execution risk.

Today, Tellie has progressed beyond concept stage and already includes:

- a live mobile product across iOS and Android
- real-time voice and chat experiences
- memory and personalization systems
- subscription infrastructure
- organizational activation flows
- usage and entitlement controls

This matters because Tellie is no longer an idea seeking validation at the product level. The remaining challenge is market validation, user acquisition, retention, and scalable distribution.

Enterprise validation and strategic setback

During development, Tellie identified a significant B2B opportunity with a large health insurer in Latin America. The proposed collaboration explored how Tellie's conversational and voice capabilities could support a preventive-health and voice-analysis protocol.

The commercial pathway discussed included:

- an initial validation cohort of approximately 10,000 users
- a potential broader rollout to approximately 1.4 million insured members
- insurer-backed infrastructure and development support for the protocol integration

Although the opportunity did not ultimately proceed because the insurer entered an M&A process and strategic priorities changed, the engagement provided meaningful validation that a large enterprise stakeholder saw value in Tellie's platform beyond companionship alone.

What this history demonstrates

Tellie's journey shows:

- founder resilience under difficult operating conditions
- product execution before outside funding
- early evidence of enterprise interest
- platform potential beyond a narrow consumer companion use case

Problem

The world is aging

Developed nations are aging rapidly. Australia, the United States, the United Kingdom, Canada, and New Zealand all have growing 65+ populations, increasing strain on healthcare systems, care networks, and community support structures.

Loneliness and social isolation are serious public-health issues

Research cited in the source register indicates:

- WHO reports that 1 in 6 people globally experience loneliness
- WHO links loneliness and social isolation to approximately 871,000 deaths annually
- The U.S. Surgeon General associates social disconnection with depression, anxiety, dementia, stroke, cardiovascular disease, and premature mortality
- Older adults are disproportionately vulnerable because of retirement, loss of partners, reduced mobility, shrinking social circles, and family dispersion

Digital exclusion amplifies the problem

The opportunity is not only to reduce loneliness. It is to reduce digital exclusion, which affects:

- social participation
- confidence
- independence
- access to services
- family connection
- local engagement
- healthy aging

Many seniors do have access to devices, but struggle with:

- complex interfaces
- lack of confidence
- fear of making mistakes
- products designed for younger users
- inaccessible or cognitively demanding workflows

Why existing solutions fall short

General-purpose AI

Products like ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude are powerful but not optimized for older adults. They are broad, feature-heavy, and not built around emotional safety, simplicity, or senior-specific interaction design.

Human companion services

Human support is valuable but expensive, geographically limited, and difficult to scale.

Companion robots

Products such as ElliQ show that the market exists, but hardware introduces adoption friction, setup complexity, and higher acquisition cost.

Solution

Tellie is a voice-first AI companion designed specifically for older adults. It is not intended to replace human relationships. It is intended to multiply moments of connection and provide support when family, carers, or community are not immediately available.

The product's design thesis is that older adults may not be comfortable navigating advanced software, but most are comfortable making a phone call. Tellie therefore presents itself through a familiar call-like experience rather than a complex AI workspace.

Product And How It Works

Product philosophy

Tellie is built around one central product question:

'What can an older adult already do comfortably?'

The answer is: call.

This is why Tellie is designed to feel like a phone call rather than a traditional AI tool. The product reduces adoption friction by matching an existing user habit instead of requiring a new one.

Elder-driven interface

Tellie's user experience is intentionally optimized for older adults:

- voice-first interaction
- minimal screen complexity
- low cognitive load
- familiar communication patterns
- slower, gentler pacing
- emotional comfort
- large, simple interaction cues

The goal is not to expose the full power of AI. The goal is to make technology disappear into a familiar and dignified interaction.

AI orchestration layer

Tellie is not simply a thin wrapper around a model. It is an orchestration system designed to create a senior-specific companion experience by coordinating:

- real-time voice interaction
- text-based conversation
- personalized memory
- user profile context
- multilingual conversation
- reminders and check-ins

- entitlement and usage controls
- enterprise and activation-code flows
- future family and wellbeing signals

Current codebase-backed product context

Based on the current repository, Tellie already has:

- a Flutter mobile application for iOS and Android
- an Express and TypeScript backend
- Firebase-backed authentication and data infrastructure
- OpenAI-backed chat and realtime voice flows
- subscription handling for Apple and Google Play
- enterprise and organizational activation flows
- chat persistence, voice messaging, and usage accounting

Current capabilities

- real-time voice conversations
- text chat
- long-term memory and personalized context
- multilingual support
- stories and conversational entertainment
- freemium and paid subscriptions
- organizational activation codes

Near-term roadmap

- reminders
- check-ins
- medication reminders
- onboarding improvements
- family dashboard v1
- usage and wellbeing summaries
- community activity discovery

Long-term roadmap

Stage 1: Companion

- conversation
- emotional support

- memory
- entertainment

Stage 2: Wellbeing

- check-ins
- reminders
- family reassurance
- mood-aware engagement

Stage 3: Community

- local activity discovery
- council events
- community engagement
- social recommendations

Stage 4: Healthy Aging Platform

- longitudinal wellbeing support
- lifestyle insights
- care coordination support
- doctor visit summary support
- healthy aging context

Product boundary

Tellie should avoid making medical, diagnostic, treatment, or prevention claims unless and until an appropriate regulatory and clinical pathway is established.

Market Opportunity

Why now

Three trends support the market opportunity:

- Aging populations are expanding across core English-speaking markets.
- Loneliness and social isolation are increasingly treated as public-health and economic issues.
- Conversational AI is now mature enough to support scalable, natural dialogue at consumer level.

Demographic shift: the inversion of the population pyramid

One of the most important macro trends underpinning Tellie is population aging.

Historically, many countries resembled a population pyramid, with large younger populations supporting relatively smaller older populations. Across developed economies, that structure is shifting because of declining birth rates and increasing life expectancy. The result is an increasingly top-heavy or inverted age profile, with more older adults and proportionally fewer younger people.

This is not a temporary anomaly. It is one of the most predictable long-term demographic changes underway.

According to the Australian Institute of Health and Welfare, older Australians already represented more than one in six Australians in 2020, and people aged 65 and over are projected to represent 21% to 23% of the population by 2066. The Australian Government's Intergenerational Report identifies population aging as one of the major structural forces shaping the country's future economy and care burden.

In the United States, the U.S. Census Bureau reported that the 65+ population reached 61.2 million in 2024, representing 18.0% of the population. Across other core Tellie markets including the United Kingdom, Canada, and New Zealand, official statistics show the same directional trend: the senior share of the population continues to rise.

At global level, the United Nations has projected that population aging will continue accelerating over coming decades, fundamentally reshaping healthcare demand, family structures, social support systems, and the design requirements for consumer technology.

For Tellie, this matters because the company is not being built for a temporary niche. It is being built against one of the largest and most predictable demographic transitions of the century.

Why mobile first, not robotics

Several companies in the healthy-aging and companionship space are investing in robotics. Tellie believes robotics may become an important part of the future, but that the right initial market strategy is mobile-first.

Today's seniors are not tomorrow's seniors

For the next 10 to 15 years, a large share of older adults will still be less digitally native than the generations that follow them. Many continue to experience friction with:

- new interfaces
- setup-heavy devices

- product onboarding
- digital confidence

At the same time, smartphones have already achieved much broader familiarity than dedicated robots or new hardware categories.

Trust comes before hardware

Tellie's thesis is that companionship is fundamentally a trust problem before it is a hardware problem.

Older adults are unlikely to adopt unfamiliar devices or robotic companions at scale unless trust has already been established. By delivering companionship through devices seniors or their families already understand, Tellie can focus first on what matters most:

- trust
- habit
- emotional connection
- longitudinal relationship building

Once those are established, new form factors become easier to introduce.

Building for the current wave, preparing for the next

Tellie's immediate opportunity is today's older adult population. By serving this generation now, the company aims to earn trust from the hardest cohort to win: seniors who are most likely to need digital simplicity and most likely to distrust unfamiliar technology.

That creates long-term strategic value in the form of:

- user trust
- family trust
- behavioral and relationship data
- brand recognition
- channel partnerships

As the next generation of older adults ages into the market, digital literacy will likely be materially higher. Many of those future seniors will already have used smartphones, voice interfaces, AI tools, and other connected technologies for decades. At that point, Tellie expects additional expansion opportunities across:

- dedicated companion devices

- smart home integrations
- wearables
- robotics

Strategic advantage for investors

Every robotics company must solve:

- hardware
- manufacturing
- distribution
- companionship
- trust

Tellie only needs to solve:

- companionship
- trust

That makes the mobile-first strategy a competitive advantage, not a limitation.

It enables:

- lower capital requirements
- faster iteration cycles
- faster distribution
- quicker product-market fit validation
- optionality for future hardware expansion

Mobile is not Tellie's final form factor. Mobile is Tellie's fastest path to becoming the trusted relationship layer for older adults.

Market framing

Tellie should not be positioned narrowly as "an AI companion." The stronger frame is:

'A healthy-aging and digital-inclusion company powered by AI.'

This positioning:

- enlarges the addressable market
- reduces platform-risk concerns
- aligns with impact investors
- aligns with aged-care and community partners

- supports future expansion beyond companionship

TAM, SAM, SOM

The following figures are directional planning ranges based on the source register and founder strategy discussion. They should be refreshed before external circulation.

Total Addressable Market

Tellie's long-term TAM is the English-speaking older adult population plus institutions that support healthy aging.

| Market | 65+ Population Basis | Directional Addressable User Base |
Illustrative Annual TAM | | --- | ---: | ---: | ---: | | Australia | ~4.4M |
~3.0M smartphone-capable seniors | USD \$450M-\$1.1B | | United States | ~56M to
61.2M | ~40M smartphone-capable seniors | USD \$6B-\$14B | | United Kingdom | ~12M
| ~8M+ | USD \$1.5B-\$3B | | Canada | ~7M | ~5M+ | USD \$800M-\$2B | | New Zealand |
~0.9M | ~0.6M+ | USD \$100M-\$250M |

Combined directional TAM: approximately USD \$9B-\$20B+ annually.

Serviceable Available Market

Tellie's initial SAM is narrower than the full senior population. It includes seniors who are:

- English-speaking
- living independently or semi-independently
- experiencing loneliness, isolation, or digital exclusion
- capable of using a smartphone or tablet
- reachable directly or through family and institutional channels

Directional SAM: 8M-15M users across initial English-speaking markets.

Serviceable Obtainable Market

Short- to medium-term operating targets:

- 5-year target: 100,000 active seniors
- 10-year target: 1,000,000 active seniors

Even at 100,000 active seniors, Tellie would still serve a very small fraction of the available market.

Customer Segments

Primary user

- older adults, initially skewing toward ages 70-80

Primary buyer

- adult children concerned about the wellbeing, loneliness, or digital exclusion of aging parents

Secondary buyers and channel partners

- community centers
- local councils
- healthy aging programs
- home care providers
- aged-care facilities

Competitive Landscape

Tellie sits at the intersection of:

- healthy aging
- digital inclusion
- AI companionship
- wellbeing technology

Category 1: General AI

ChatGPT / OpenAI

Strengths:

- best-in-class model capability
- strong brand awareness
- rapid product evolution

Weaknesses relative to Tellie:

- not designed for older adults
- general-purpose experience
- can feel cognitively overwhelming
- limited senior-specific onboarding and emotional framing

Gemini

Strengths:

- strong distribution ecosystem
- broad AI capability

Weaknesses relative to Tellie:

- not senior-specific
- general-purpose experience

Claude

Strengths:

- high-quality conversational capability

Weaknesses relative to Tellie:

- not optimized for older adults
- no healthy-aging focus

Category 2: Senior-focused companion hardware

ElliQ

Closest conceptual benchmark.

Strengths:

- explicitly designed for older adults
- strong companionship positioning
- caregiver and wellness framing

Weaknesses relative to Tellie:

- hardware dependency
- acquisition and deployment friction
- setup complexity
- higher cost to scale

Tellie advantage:

- no dedicated hardware required
- faster onboarding
- lower deployment friction
- uses devices seniors or families already own

Ato

Strengths:

- voice-first companionship framing
- family reassurance angle

Weaknesses relative to Tellie:

- hardware-centered model
- additional deployment friction

Tellie advantage:

- mobile-first
- lower upfront cost
- broader geographic scalability

Category 3: Safety and monitoring products

Examples include:

- smartwatches
- pendants
- fall detection products
- monitoring systems

These are mostly adjacent, not direct competitors. They solve safety. Tellie solves connection and digital inclusion. Many may become partners rather than competitors.

Category 4: Human and community services

Examples include:

- home care
- companion services
- community organizations
- council healthy-aging programs

These should often be treated as distribution partners, not replacements.

Tellie's moat

Tellie's moat is not the raw model, voice itself, or AI memory alone. Those are increasingly commoditized. The moat is the combination of:

- senior-specific product design
- trusted emotional experience
- longitudinal relationship memory
- family and wellbeing context over time
- strong elder-centered interface design
- institutional distribution potential

Business Model

Tellie should operate a hybrid B2C and B2B model.

B2C

Free tier

Purpose:

- acquisition
- trial
- habit formation

Recommended controls:

- limited interactions
- memory restrictions
- usage caps

Starter tier

- target price: USD \$12.99/month
- target use case: moderate engagement

Premium tier

- target price: USD \$29.99/month
- target use case: heavier users, richer experience, future premium wellbeing/family features

B2B

Facility and organizational licensing

Potential structures:

- per-seat pricing
- facility licenses
- annual contracts
- activation-code bundles

Potential customer types:

- community centers
- councils
- home care providers

- aged-care facilities
- healthy aging programs

Revenue thesis

Near term:

- B2C is the wedge

Long term:

- B2B likely becomes the stronger revenue accelerator because institutions already have budgets for wellbeing, engagement, loneliness, community participation, and resident experience

Go-To-Market Strategy

Phase 1: Validation

Timeframe: 0-12 months

Objective:

- prove older adults will use Tellie repeatedly

Channels:

- community centers
- senior clubs
- family referrals
- founder network

Target proof points:

- 100 active seniors
- 20 interviews
- 20 testimonials
- measurable retention

Phase 2: Community distribution

Timeframe: 12-24 months

Objective:

- reach first 1,000 active users

Channels:

- councils
- healthy-aging programs

- community organizations

Phase 3: Family acquisition

Timeframe: 18-36 months

Objective:

- scale through adult children

Channels:

- Facebook and family-targeted digital advertising
- referrals
- partnership distribution

Core message:

‘Help your loved one stay connected.’

Phase 4: Institutional expansion

Timeframe: 24-60 months

Target customers:

- home care providers
- aged-care facilities
- government or community programs

Objective:

- build repeatable B2B revenue

Marketing Strategy

Tellie’s marketing strategy should be built around trust, education, and distribution efficiency rather than broad early-stage paid spend. Because the end user is an older adult but the economic buyer is often an adult child or institutional partner, Tellie must market to multiple audiences with different emotional triggers and decision criteria.

Marketing objectives

The marketing function should support four primary objectives:

- generate qualified awareness among adult children and family decision-makers
- build trust with older adults through simple, reassuring brand presentation
- create low-cost distribution through community and institutional partners
- convert product usage and testimonials into increasingly efficient acquisition

Core positioning

Tellie's marketing should consistently reinforce the idea that it is not simply an AI app. It is an empathetic, senior-first technology experience designed to help older adults feel connected, supported, and included.

Recommended positioning language:

- healthy aging and digital inclusion platform
- voice-first companion designed for older adults
- technology that feels familiar, simple, and human

Primary audience segments

Adult children

This is likely the highest-value early B2C buyer segment.

Core motivations:

- concern about a parent's loneliness
- desire for reassurance when family lives far away
- guilt about not always being available
- desire to support independence without creating more complexity

Core messages:

- help your loved one stay connected
- give them a companion they can talk to anytime
- simple enough for older adults, meaningful enough for families

Older adults

This segment needs low-friction trust-building rather than aggressive performance marketing.

Core motivations:

- companionship
- feeling heard
- ease of use
- curiosity without intimidation

Core messages:

- just talk, like a phone call
- simple, warm, and made for you

- no technical knowledge required

Institutional buyers

This includes councils, community centers, home care providers, and aged-care facilities.

Core motivations:

- resident or member wellbeing
- engagement outcomes
- low-friction implementation
- scalable support without hiring proportional staff

Core messages:

- improve social connection and engagement for older adults
- deploy without hardware complexity
- launch pilots quickly and measure usage and satisfaction

Channel strategy

1. Community-led acquisition

This should be Tellie's first and most credible acquisition channel.

Examples:

- community centers
- seniors groups
- libraries
- councils
- healthy aging programs
- church and cultural communities

Strategic role:

- builds trust through institutions seniors already know
- lowers adoption friction
- creates early case studies and testimonials

2. Family-targeted digital marketing

This should be the main scalable B2C acquisition engine once onboarding and retention are working.

Priority channels:

- Facebook
- Instagram
- Google Search
- YouTube
- remarketing campaigns

Why these channels matter:

- adult children are easier to target digitally than seniors
- intent-based acquisition can align to loneliness, aging parents, and staying connected

Example campaign angles:

- support a parent who lives alone
- help your loved one feel less isolated
- a companion built for older adults, not tech experts

3. Referral loops

Tellie should design referral pathways for:

- adult child to parent
- sibling to sibling
- family to family
- organization to member

This is especially important because trust is transferable. A warm recommendation from a family member or trusted organization should convert better than cold paid traffic.

4. PR and thought leadership

Tellie has a strong narrative that can support earned media:

- aging population and inverted demographic pyramid
- loneliness and digital exclusion
- AI designed for older adults
- trust before hardware
- women-led founder resilience story

Potential outputs:

- founder interviews
- opinion pieces
- healthy aging podcasts
- aged-care and health-tech publications
- conference speaking

Strategic role:

- strengthens credibility
- supports fundraising
- supports B2B sales conversations

5. Partnership marketing

Tellie should pursue co-marketing and pilot visibility with:

- councils
- community organizations
- home care providers
- aged-care groups
- insurers and health-adjacent organizations where appropriate

This channel can lower CAC while increasing credibility through association.

Funnel design

Tellie's funnel should be designed differently for B2C and B2B.

B2C funnel

- Awareness
- Trust-building through simple landing page, testimonials, and explainer content
- Trial through free tier or guided onboarding
- First meaningful conversation
- Habit formation
- Upgrade to paid subscription

The most important conversion is not download to signup. It is signup to first meaningful conversation, and then first conversation to repeat habit.

B2B funnel

- Outreach or inbound interest
- Discovery conversation

- Pilot proposal
- Limited activation cohort
- KPI review
- Paid rollout

The key to B2B marketing is proving low-friction deployment and measurable engagement, not broad brand advertising.

Content strategy

Tellie's content should educate, reassure, and normalize the product category.

Priority content themes:

- loneliness and connection in later life
- digital exclusion among older adults
- how to support aging parents at a distance
- why voice-first works better for seniors
- stories of companionship, confidence, and inclusion

Priority content formats:

- short explainer videos
- testimonials
- founder story content
- partner case studies
- simple landing-page copy
- family-focused email sequences

Brand strategy

Tellie's brand should feel:

- warm
- trustworthy
- calm
- human
- dignified
- non-clinical

The company should avoid branding that feels:

- overly technical
- futuristic in a cold way

- infantilizing
- medical unless clinically justified

Budget and sequencing

Stage 1: Pre-scale marketing

Primary investments:

- community outreach
- lightweight content creation
- founder-led storytelling
- usability-informed landing page optimization
- direct partner conversations

Paid acquisition should remain limited until retention and activation are proven.

Stage 2: Early channel validation

Primary investments:

- small-budget paid experiments on Facebook and Google
- retargeting
- partnership marketing pilots
- referral incentives

Objective:

- identify one repeatable acquisition channel with acceptable CAC and payback

Stage 3: Scale marketing

Primary investments:

- performance marketing
- lifecycle CRM
- partnerships team support
- B2B case study engine
- brand and PR support

Marketing KPIs

The marketing strategy should be measured through a focused set of acquisition and efficiency metrics.

Awareness metrics

- website sessions
- landing page conversion rate
- cost per landing page visitor
- earned media mentions

Acquisition metrics

- cost per signup
- cost per activated user
- customer acquisition cost by channel
- referral rate

Activation quality metrics

- completed first conversation rate by channel
- time to first meaningful conversation by channel
- Day 7 retention by acquisition source
- Day 30 retention by acquisition source

Monetization metrics

- free-to-paid conversion by source
- payback period by channel
- LTV:CAC by channel

Partnership metrics

- number of pilot conversations initiated
- pilot conversion rate
- cost to acquire a partner
- activated seats per partner

Strategic marketing principle

Tellie should not try to win with volume first. It should win with trust first.

The most effective marketing strategy for Tellie is likely to be:

- highly credible
- emotionally resonant
- partnership-led in the beginning
- performance-scalable only after retention is proven

This approach is more disciplined, more capital-efficient, and more aligned with the nature of the product than attempting mass-market consumer acquisition too early.

KPI Framework

Tellie should be measured less like a generic consumer app and more like a relationship and behavior-formation product.

North star metric

Weekly Meaningful Conversations

Definition:

- a voice or text session lasting at least 3 minutes, or
- a conversation containing at least 6 back-and-forth exchanges

Why it matters:

- Tellie creates value when it creates repeat moments of connection

12-month target:

- 500+ weekly meaningful conversations across 100 active seniors

24-month target:

- 10,000+ weekly meaningful conversations across 2,000 active seniors

Activation metrics

Completed First Conversation Rate

Formula:

‘users completing first meaningful conversation / new registered users’

Target:

- 60%+

Time To First Meaningful Conversation

Definition:

- median time from registration to first meaningful conversation

Target:

- under 5 minutes

Onboarding Completion Rate

Definition:

- percentage of users completing core profile setup

Target:

- 70%+

Engagement metrics

Weekly Active Seniors

Definition:

- seniors completing at least one meaningful conversation per week

Targets:

- 12 months: 100
- 24 months: 2,000

Conversations Per Active User Per Week

Targets:

- 12 months: 3-5
- 24 months: 5-7

Average Conversation Duration

Targets:

- 12 months: 5-8 minutes
- 24 months: 8-12 minutes

Voice Usage Ratio

Definition:

- share of sessions completed via voice rather than text

Target:

- 70%+

Why it matters:

- validates the elder-first phone-call interaction thesis

Retention metrics

Day 1 Retention

Target:

- 35%+

Day 7 Retention

Target:

- 25%+

Day 30 Retention

Target:

- baseline 15%+

- strong signal 30%+

Month 3 Retention

Target:

- early 10%+

- strong signal 20%+

Emotional impact metrics

Self-Reported Loneliness Change

Method:

- lightweight score at onboarding and after 30 days

Target:

- 20% reduction in average loneliness score among retained users after 30 days

Feeling Heard Score

Question:

‘Did Tellie make you feel heard today?’

Target:

- 4.3+/5

Companion Perception Rate

Definition:

- share of users who describe Tellie as a companion, friend, or someone they enjoy talking to

Target:

- 40%+ by month 12

Disappointment Test

Question:

'How disappointed would you be if Tellie were no longer available?'

Target:

- 40%+ answer 'very disappointed'

Business metrics

Free-to-Paid Conversion Rate

Targets:

- early: 3%-5%
- strong signal: 8%-10%

Monthly Recurring Revenue

Targets:

- 12 months: AUD \$2k-\$5k MRR
- 24 months: AUD \$25k-\$50k MRR

Gross Margin

Definition:

- revenue after app-store fees and direct AI/infrastructure costs

Targets:

- baseline: 60%+ blended gross margin
- strong signal: 70%+

Customer Acquisition Cost

Early B2C target:

- AUD \$40-\$120

Target payback period:

- under 6 months

Lifetime Value

Target:

- LTV:CAC greater than 3:1

Partnership metrics

Community Partner Pilots

Targets:

- 12 months: 5
- 24 months: 25

Pilot-to-Contract Conversion

Target:

- 30%+

Institutional Seats Activated

Targets:

- 12 months: 100
- 24 months: 2,000

Stage gates

Stage 1: Product validation

Required proof:

- 100 active seniors
- 500 weekly meaningful conversations
- 15%+ Day 30 retention
- 20 testimonials
- 4.3+ Feeling Heard Score

Stage 2: Product-market fit signal

Required proof:

- 2,000 active seniors
- 10,000 weekly meaningful conversations
- 30%+ Day 30 retention
- 40%+ very disappointed score
- AUD \$25k+ MRR

Stage 3: Scale readiness

Required proof:

- 10,000 active seniors

- 60%+ blended gross margin
- LTV:CAC above 3:1
- at least one repeatable acquisition channel
- 25+ institutional pilots or partners

Financial Model

Financial model purpose

Tellie's financial model needs to answer four investor questions:

- Can Tellie acquire users efficiently?
- Can Tellie retain users long enough to recover acquisition cost?
- Can Tellie deliver AI-powered companionship with healthy margins?
- Can Tellie expand from B2C into more scalable B2B revenue?

Key modelling assumptions

- AI stack uses OpenAI chat and realtime voice products
- hosting baseline assumption: USD \$20/month initially
- data stack uses Google NoSQL infrastructure
- app distribution uses Apple App Store and Google Play
- conservative app store fee case: 30%
- optimized app store fee case: 15%
- free users must be tightly usage-capped
- premium usage must be governed by entitlement and cost controls

Direct cost drivers

AI costs

Primary direct costs:

- text input tokens
- text output tokens
- realtime voice input tokens
- realtime voice output tokens
- transcription or audio-related processing

App store commissions

- Apple and Google meaningfully affect consumer gross margin

Infrastructure

- hosting
- database reads/writes/storage
- bandwidth

Operating support

- customer support
- accounting
- company compliance
- insurance
- legal and data/privacy costs as the business matures

App store and platform baseline assumptions

- Apple Developer Program: USD \$99/year
- Google Play Console: USD \$25 one-time registration
- Apple small business program: eligible developers may pay 15% instead of 30%
- Google Play states most developers subject to service fees qualify for 15% or less

Database assumptions

Firestore-style usage is expected to be negligible at early stage relative to AI costs. The database becomes more material only at larger scale or with very chatty read/write patterns.

'Assumption to validate:' early-stage database cost remains under roughly USD \$50/month until usage grows materially.

Consumer pricing

| Tier | Price | Role | | --- | ---: | --- | | Free | \$0 | Acquisition and trial
| | Starter | \$12.99/month | Moderate use | | Premium | \$29.99/month | Heavier
use and future premium features |

Target AI budgets by tier

| Tier | Target Monthly AI Budget | Notes | | --- | ---: | --- | | Free |
\$0.25-\$1.00 | Strictly capped acquisition tier | | Starter | \$2.00-\$3.50 |
Designed to preserve healthy unit economics | | Premium | \$6.00-\$10.00 | Higher
use, still controlled | | Institutional | 25%-35% of contract value | Negotiated
usage envelope |

Unit economics

Starter tier at 30% store fee

- list price: USD \$12.99
- store fee: USD \$3.90
- net after store fee: USD \$9.09
- target AI and infrastructure cost: USD \$2.00-\$3.50
- gross profit: USD \$5.59-\$7.09
- gross margin: approximately 43%-55%

Starter tier at 15% store fee

- list price: USD \$12.99
- store fee: USD \$1.95
- net after store fee: USD \$11.04
- target AI and infrastructure cost: USD \$2.00-\$3.50
- gross profit: USD \$7.54-\$9.04
- gross margin: approximately 58%-70%

Premium tier at 30% store fee

- list price: USD \$29.99
- store fee: about USD \$9.00
- net after store fee: USD \$20.99
- target AI and infrastructure cost: USD \$6.00-\$10.00
- gross profit: USD \$10.99-\$14.99
- gross margin: approximately 37%-50%

Premium tier at 15% store fee

- list price: USD \$29.99
- store fee: about USD \$4.50
- net after store fee: USD \$25.49
- target AI and infrastructure cost: USD \$6.00-\$10.00
- gross profit: USD \$15.49-\$19.49
- gross margin: approximately 52%-65%

Important economic conclusion

Tellie cannot price unlimited high-cost realtime voice usage into a flat consumer subscription without controls. The business must manage usage like an AI company, not like an uncapped calling plan.

Required cost controls

- monthly usage caps
- soft throttling
- conversation summarization
- memory compression
- cached context where practical
- model routing
- shorter context windows
- voice session limits by tier
- B2B usage bundles
- internal alerts for margin erosion

3-year directional model

Year 1: Validation

Assumptions:

- 1,000 registered users
- 100 weekly active seniors
- 50 paying subscribers
- 5 small pilots
- blended consumer ARPU: about USD \$18/month

Directional output:

- consumer MRR: about USD \$900
- ARR: about USD \$10,800

Interpretation:

- financially small, strategically valuable
- year focused on product truth, not revenue scale

Year 2: Early growth

Assumptions:

- 10,000 registered users
- 2,000 active seniors
- 500 paying subscribers
- 10 institutional partners
- blended subscription ARPU: about USD \$20/month

Directional output:

- consumer MRR: about USD \$10,000
- institutional MRR: USD \$10,000-\$25,000
- total MRR: USD \$20,000-\$35,000
- ARR: USD \$240,000-\$420,000

Year 3: Scale preparation

Assumptions:

- 50,000 registered users
- 10,000 active seniors
- 2,500 paying subscribers
- 50 institutional partners

Directional output:

- consumer MRR: about USD \$50,000
- institutional MRR: USD \$75,000-\$150,000
- total MRR: USD \$125,000-\$200,000
- ARR: USD \$1.5M-\$2.4M

Burn-rate scenarios

Bootstrap stage

- monthly burn: USD \$1,000-\$5,000

Includes:

- hosting
- AI usage
- software tools
- limited legal and accounting
- founder-led testing

Pre-seed stage

- monthly burn: USD \$15,000-\$40,000

Includes:

- founder support
- contractors
- product iteration

- customer interviews
- pilot support
- legal, privacy, and compliance setup

Seed stage

- monthly burn: USD \$80,000-\$180,000

Includes:

- core team
- growth
- B2B sales
- product development
- customer success
- compliance expansion

Funding Strategy

Bootstrap phase

Objective:

- reach product validation and first retention proof

Indicative capital need:

- USD \$25,000-\$100,000

Use of funds:

- AI usage
- community pilots
- product refinement
- onboarding
- lightweight acquisition testing

Pre-seed raise

Recommended range:

- USD \$250,000-\$500,000

Objective:

- prove product-market fit signal and repeatable acquisition

Use of funds:

- product development

- growth experiments
- founder runway
- early B2B pilots
- privacy, legal, and operating setup

Seed raise

Recommended range:

- USD \$1.5M-\$3M

Objective:

- scale validated channels and institutional sales

Use of funds:

- growth team
- product team
- customer success
- B2B sales
- market expansion
- compliance infrastructure

Team Strategy

Current founding profile

The founder brings product vision, mission clarity, empathy-driven market insight, and category conviction.

Missing capabilities likely required

- growth and lifecycle marketing
- B2B partnerships and sales
- financial modelling and fundraising support
- product analytics and experimentation

Recommended co-founder or first senior hire profile

Best-fit profiles:

- growth / marketing operator with consumer and partnership experience
- partnerships / B2B sales leader with aged-care or community channel credibility

'Assumption to validate:' future co-founder equity range likely needs explicit founder decision before fundraising outreach.

Risks And Mitigation

User adoption risk

Risk:

- seniors may not adopt or repeat usage at expected levels

Mitigation:

- community-first pilots
- phone-call-style onboarding
- heavy usability iteration

Retention risk

Risk:

- novelty may not convert into durable habit

Mitigation:

- optimize for weekly meaningful conversations
- measure emotional value, not just activity

AI cost risk

Risk:

- realtime voice usage could erode margins

Mitigation:

- tiered usage controls
- model optimization
- entitlement limits
- enterprise bundles

Competitive/platform risk

Risk:

- general AI platforms could add senior-friendly features

Mitigation:

- build distribution, trust, senior-specific UX, and longitudinal relationship data

Regulatory risk

Risk:

- the product could drift into regulated health territory

Mitigation:

- remain in companionship and wellbeing framing until a formal regulatory strategy is established

B2B sales cycle risk

Risk:

- institutional contracts may be slow

Mitigation:

- start with low-friction pilots through community and council channels

Strategic Positioning Recommendation

Tellie should be pitched as:

‘An empathetic healthy-aging and digital-inclusion platform for older adults, powered by AI.’

This is stronger than pitching it as:

- only an AI startup
- only a loneliness startup
- only a companion app

That positioning improves:

- market size narrative
- partnership potential
- defensibility story
- investor attractiveness

5-Year And Long-Term Vision

5-year ambition

Tellie becomes a trusted platform for older adults across Australia, with early international traction and institutional partnerships.

Long-term ambition

Tellie supports more than one million older adults by helping them feel:

- connected
- supported

- included
- valued
- more confident using technology

Success should be measured not only in ARR, but in whether Tellie becomes the most trusted technology experience for older adults.

Sources Register

The following sources were identified in the founder research process and should be kept with the business plan. Official sources should be prioritized in investor-facing versions.

Demographics and aging

- AIHW Older Australians demographic profile:
<<https://www.aihw.gov.au/reports/older-people/older-australians/contents/demographic-profile>>
- AIHW Profile of Australia's population:
<<https://www.aihw.gov.au/reports/australias-welfare/profile-of-australias-population>>
- ABS Population Projections Australia:
<<https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/population/population-projections-australia>>
- Australian Government Intergenerational Report:
<<https://treasury.gov.au/publication/2023-intergenerational-report>>
- U.S. Census Bureau older adults release:
<<https://www.census.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2025/older-adults-outnumber-children.html>>
- ONS population aged 65 and over:
<<https://www.ons.gov.uk/explore-local-statistics/indicators/percentage-population-aged-65>>
- Statistics Canada older adults and aging:
<https://www.statcan.gc.ca/en/subjects-start/older_adults_and_population_aging>
- Stats NZ older people: <<https://www.stats.govt.nz/topics/older-people/>>
- United Nations World Population Ageing:
<<https://www.un.org/development/desa/pd/content/World-Population-Ageing-2023>>

Loneliness and public-health impact

- WHO Commission on Social Connection:
<<https://www.who.int/groups/commission-on-social-connection/report/>>
- WHO social connection and early death release:
<<https://www.who.int/news/item/30-06-2025-social-connection-linked-to-improved-health-and-reduced-risk-of-e>>
- WHO social isolation and loneliness:
<<https://www.who.int/teams/social-determinants-of-health/demographic-change-and-healthy-ageing/social-isol>>

- U.S. Surgeon General advisory:
<<https://www.hhs.gov/sites/default/files/surgeon-general-social-connection-advisory.pdf>>
- National Academies report: <<https://www.nationalacademies.org/read/25663>>
- AIHW social isolation and loneliness:
<<https://www.aihw.gov.au/mental-health/topic-areas/social-isolation-and-loneliness>>
- Ending Loneliness Together report:
<https://endingloneliness.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2023/10/ELT_LNA_Report_Digital.pdf>
- Lancet Healthy Longevity article:
<[https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanhl/article/PIIS2666-7568\(25\)00001-7/fulltext](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanhl/article/PIIS2666-7568(25)00001-7/fulltext)>
- Age UK loneliness research:
<<https://www.ageuk.org.uk/our-impact/policy-research/loneliness-research-and-resources/>>

Digital adoption and exclusion

- ACMA communications and media in Australia:
<<https://www.acma.gov.au/communications-and-media-australia>>
- auDA Digital Lives of Australians 2024:
<<https://files.auda.org.au/documents/Digital-Lives-of-Australians-2024-report.pdf>>
- Australian Government digital exclusion report:
<<https://www.infrastructure.gov.au/sites/default/files/documents/digital-exclusion-in-australia-report.pdf>>
- Benetas digital habits of older Australians:
<<https://www.benetas.com.au/news/digital-habits-of-older-australians>>
- Pew mobile fact sheet:
<<https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/fact-sheet/mobile/>>

Aged care and care delivery market

- GEN aged care data snapshot:
<<https://www.gen-agedcaredata.gov.au/resources/access-data/2024/october/aged-care-data-snapshot-2024>>
- GEN aged care data home: <<https://www.gen-agedcaredata.gov.au/>>
- AIHW aged care overview:
<<https://www.aihw.gov.au/reports/australias-welfare/aged-care>>
- Home Care Packages Program Data Report:
<<https://www.gen-agedcaredata.gov.au/getmedia/99a876cc-1cc2-4a96-88df-fb25051d87d9/Home-Care-Packages-Program-Data-Report>>

Market sizing and category reports

- AARP AgeTech release:
<<https://www.aarp.org/press/releases/2025-1-8-new-report-finds-growing-interest-tech-aging-well-home.html>>
- TheGerontechnologist market map: <<https://thegerontechnologist.com/>>
- Aging and Health Technology Watch:
<<https://www.ageinplacetech.com/page/2024-market-overview-technology-aging-january-2024>>

- Grand View Research AI companion market:
<<https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/ai-companion-market-report>>
- Global Market Insights AI companion app market:
<<https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/ai-companion-app-market>>
- TechSci Australia digital health market:
<<https://www.techsciresearch.com/report/australia-digital-health-market/29994.html>>
- Fortune Business Insights elderly care market:
<<https://www.fortunebusinessinsights.com/elderly-care-market-111477>>

Competitors

- ElliQ: <<https://elliq.com/>>
- Intuition Robotics: <<https://www.intuitionrobotics.com/>>
- The Verge ElliQ pricing article:
<<https://www.theverge.com/2025/1/6/24334149/elliq-robot-aging-in-place-tech-smart-home>>
- Wired ElliQ review: <<https://www.wired.com/review/elliq-ai-companion-robot/>>
- Ato PRWeb release:
<<https://www.prweb.com/releases/ato-is-the-voice-first-ai-companion-to-combat-senior-loneliness-and-empow>>
- Ato / Founders Inc profile: <<https://f.inc/portfolio/ato/>>
- Nobi: <https://www.nobi.life/en_GB>
- Nobi product: <<https://www.nobi.life/en/product>>
- CarePredict: <<https://shop.carepredict.com/collections/all>>

Regulation

- TGA software-based medical devices guidance:
<<https://www.tga.gov.au/resources/guidance/understanding-how-we-regulate-software-based-medical-devices>>
- TGA software-based medical device exclusions:
<<https://www.tga.gov.au/products/medical-devices/software-and-artificial-intelligence-ai/overview/software-bas>>
- NSW Clinical Excellence Commission factsheet:
<https://www.cec.health.nsw.gov.au/__data/assets/pdf_file/0010/952966/Factsheet-Software-based-medical-d>

Financial model inputs

- OpenAI API pricing: <<https://openai.com/api/pricing/>>
- Apple Small Business Program:
<<https://developer.apple.com/app-store/small-business-program/>>
- Apple Developer Program: <<https://developer.apple.com/programs/whats-included/>>
- Google Play service fee overview:
<<https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/10632485>>

- Google Play Console registration fee:
<<https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/6112435>>
- Firestore pricing: <<https://firebase.google.com/docs/firestore/pricing>>

Final Notes

This document is already strong enough to use as a serious internal strategy document and as a base for investor materials. Before external fundraising, the next upgrade should focus on:

- validating product usage and retention with real pilot data
- converting this draft into a spreadsheet-based financial model
- pressure-testing TAM, pricing, and gross margin assumptions
- refining the B2B packaging and pilot offer
- turning the strongest sections into a pitch deck narrative